

## Public Administration

### Master of Public Administration

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#### PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

The Master of Public Administration (MPA) program will prepare students for a leadership career within private, nonprofit, public service organizations, communities, and leadership careers in public administration. The 36 credit hour program, consists of four specializations: Criminal Justice Administration, Emergency Management Homeland Security Administration, and Organizational Development and Governance. The MPA program is offered in a non-thesis hybrid format. Seventy-five percent of the program will be offered using the online delivery mode while 25% will be offered in the traditional on-campus mode. The core courses are required to be part of the 25% on-campus mode.

The program is designed to be responsive to the needs of a diverse population and the social and economic needs of the state and region. The program will focus on the regulatory, political, economic, social, and cultural environments and the theories and concepts that influence management and evaluation of diverse public service organizations, programs and processes. With this focus, the curriculum presents social entrepreneurial and business approaches to publicservice issues and opportunities at the state, county and local levels of government. The program will emphasize adherence to the values and ethical principles of the public administration profession in all aspects of public service.

#### ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Please see the general graduate admission requirements [here](#).

Specific requirements to this program are as follows:

- Official test scores of the Graduate Record Examination (GRE) or the Graduate Management Admission Test (GMAT) is required for many programs. A score of 350 on the GMAT or 146 in the verbal and 140 in the quantitative section of the GRE is required. The test score requirement may be waived for an applicant who can verify that he/she has ten or more years of leadership experience or a 3.0 GPA on a 4.0-point scale

#### DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

The MPA degree program is a 36-credit hour program, organized into four major components:

- Core courses (12 credit hours). To be completed in the traditional on-campus mode.
- Specialization (18 credit hours). The MPA program director, in consultation with the students' academic advisor, will determine the appropriate specialization for the student. In making that decision, consideration will be given to the student's prior or current career experience and/or area of future career interest based upon the student's chosen specialization. A number of elective

courses are provided for the student in various fields of specialization to complete 75% of the program offering.

- Master's Report (6 credit hours). Capstone course or independent study course is expected to allow the student the opportunity to make a theoretical contribution to the field of public administration and or techniques and strategies for solving practical problems in the broad field of Public Administration.

Students will be required to complete the 12 credit hours of core courses prior to engaging in the capstone course or independent study.

In all instances, only students with a GPA of 3.5 or a combination of the following: higher, executive service rank, advanced certifications, advanced academic degree, more than 5 years supervisory experience in a public service or corporate environment may be approved for the Independent Study option.

- Comprehensive Exam.

#### (PAD) Public Administration – Non-Thesis

36 Credit Hours

MinGPA cumulative 3.0. MinGrade B\*. Degree M.P.A.

| REQUIRED/CORE COURSES                                         |    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| PAD 500 Seminar in Public Administration                      | 3  |
| PAD 501 Research Methods in Public Admin                      | 3  |
| PAD 502 Organizational Theory and Human Behavior              | 3  |
| PAD 503 Budgeting & Public Finance                            | 3  |
| <b>SPECIALIZATION</b>                                         | 15 |
| <b>MASTER'S REPORT<sup>1</sup></b>                            |    |
| PAD 599 Capstone Project <b>OR</b> Independent Study<br>[RPP] | 6  |
| PAD 598 Research Design                                       | 3  |
| <b>COMPREHENSIVE EXAM</b>                                     |    |
| Grade is Pass / Fail.                                         |    |
| Written exam composed jointly by Advisory Committee.          |    |
| To be taken after completion of required coursework.          |    |

\*One grade of C allowed at graduation.

[RPP] = Research project paper or portfolio required.

<sup>1</sup> Completion of Core courses required before beginning Master's Report.

#### (PAD-ODG) ORGANIZATIONAL DEVELOPMENT & GOVERNANCE

##### SPECIALIZATION

|                                                  |   |
|--------------------------------------------------|---|
| PAD 510 Strategic Planning and Management        | 3 |
| PAD 512 Social Justice & Equity                  | 3 |
| PAD 513 Human Resource Management                | 3 |
| PAD 514 Ethics and Administrative Responsibility | 3 |
| PAD 515 Leadership in Organizations              | 3 |